



CHURN!

Why we developed “Churn!”

The game was created to:

- Help people outside government understand how policy making works from a civil servant’s perspective
- Illustrate the difficulty of long-term policy making when ministers and staff change jobs frequently
- Highlight the importance of evidence in policy making by rewarding activity such as consultation, scrutiny, and expertise

Why a board game?

- Interactive experience makes it fun and memorable
- Concepts emerge organically through gameplay
- Develop empathy for policy makers and the challenges they face



Churn – key concepts

Aim: to create a policy that works and stands the test of time

Who: You are in charge of a team of civil servants working for a minister.

How: Staff generate different types of resources. The longer your staff stay in post, the more productive they get.

Use resources to:

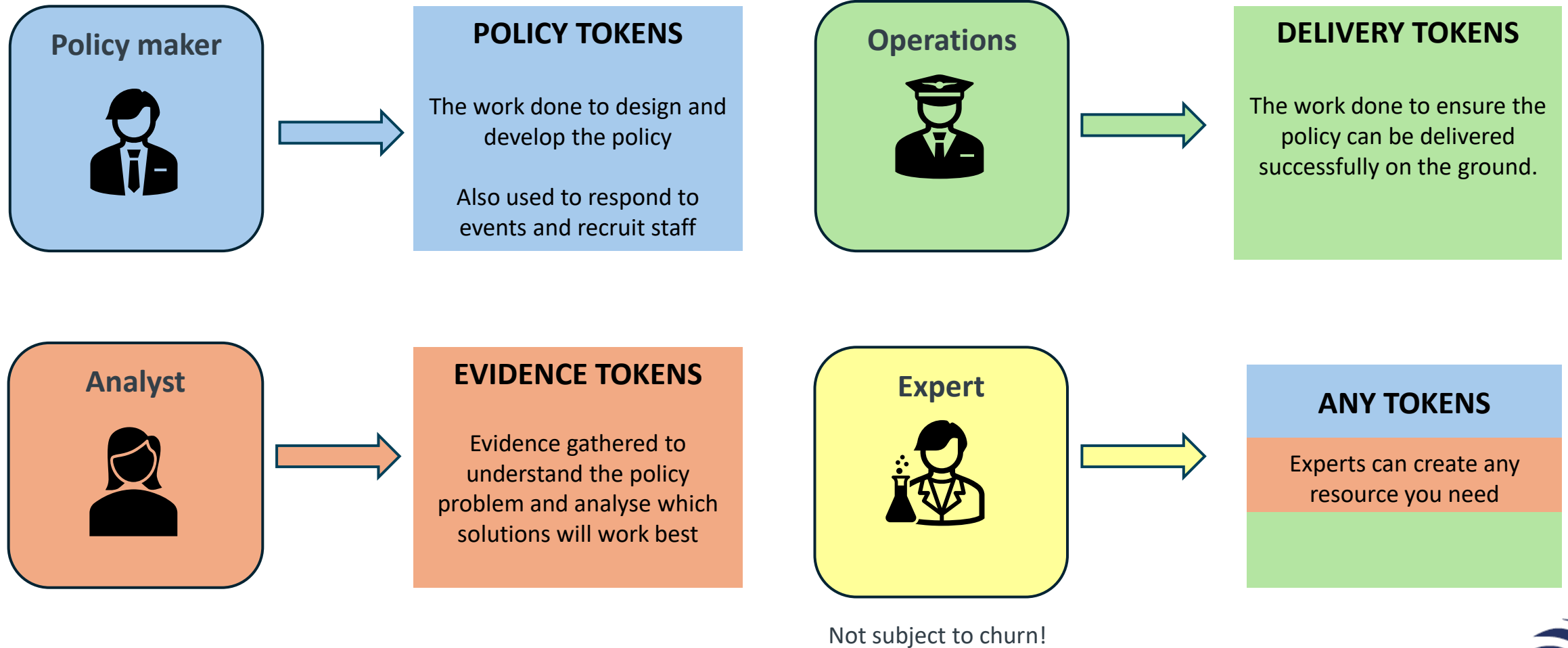
- Respond to short-term policy demands
- Pay for “resilience activities” that help your policy work effectively.
- Recruit more staff – just in case you lose some along the way*

When: The game is played over 6 rounds, representing a Parliament – i.e. the time in between elections

* You definitely will



Staff and resources



Playing the game

Each round represents a stage of policy development and is in two phases.

In Phase A, players draw cards and roll dice to collect resource tokens and find out what they need to respond to this round. This includes:

- Volatility events
- Political events
- Policy events
- Churn

In Phase B, players make decisions about how to respond to these events. After they've dealt with the above, they can:

- Purchase “resilience” activities to strengthen policies
- Recruit more staff



Volatility events



REARRANGING THE DECKCHAIRS

There are rumours of an imminent reshuffle

INCREASE VOLATILITY BY 1 POINT
VOLATILITY EVENT

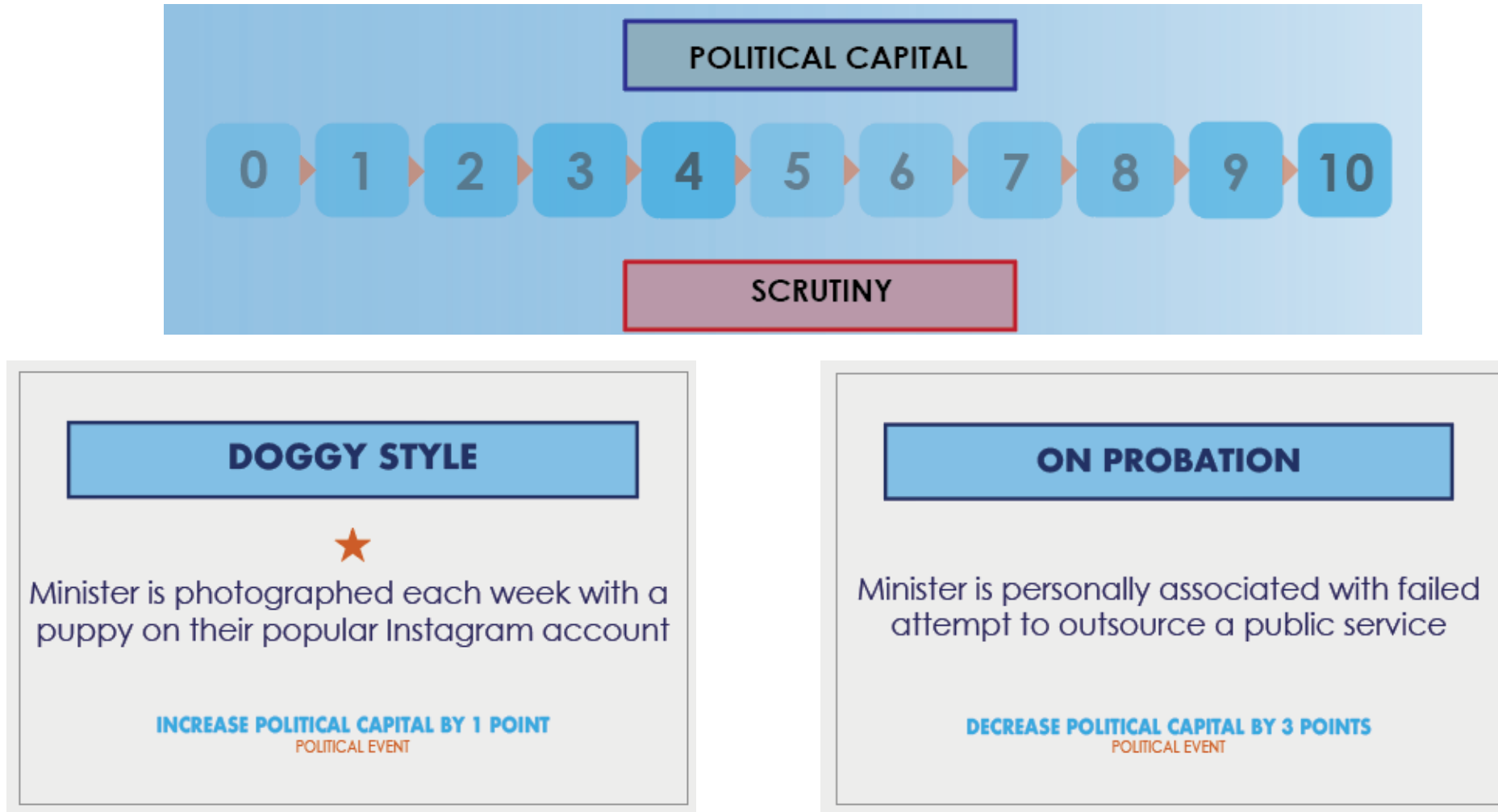
HALCYON DAYS

Summer recess sees glorious weather
and England winning the Ashes

VOLATILITY REMAINS THE SAME
VOLATILITY EVENT



Political events



Policy events

THE FULLEST POSSIBLE USE

Your minister requests that you showcase AI solutions to various policy issues

REQUIRES 2 POLICY RESPONSE POINTS
POLICY EVENT

U-TURN IF YOU WANT TO

Celebrity-led campaign gathers public support, forcing minister to act

REQUIRES 2 POLICY RESPONSE POINTS
POLICY EVENT

THEY WERE VALUES NOT DATES

Key database is found to have been compiled in Excel, leading to serious errors

REQUIRES 3 POLICY RESPONSE POINTS
POLICY EVENT

WOKE ME UP BEFORE YOU GO GO

EDI and Wellbeing initiatives result in greater retention of staff

AVOID THE NEXT CHURN INCIDENT
POLICY EVENT



Resilience activities and scrutiny

Round in which resilience activity is available

2

EXTENSIVE CONSULTATION AND WHITE PAPER

What it is: A white paper sets out the policy problem and how it will be addressed. It is made public and discussed in Parliament.

Why it helps: Enables you to test ideas with parliament, experts and the public.

POLITICAL CAPITAL

2

POLICY

3

EVIDENCE

3

DELIVERY

0

RESILIENCE

15

SCRUTINY

2

Cost of resilience activity in Political Capital and tokens

Scrutiny points – accumulated as you buy more activities

Resilience points – count to end of game total



Special abilities

Each team gets one special ability.

They can be played at any time (but only once).

MANAGED MOVE

You have excellent networks in this policy area.

Play this card to swap one of your staff members for a different role at the same level.

(VERY) SPECIAL ADVISER

Your minister's special adviser is a seasoned political operator.

Play this card to prevent one ministerial resignation
(ignore the card that causes minister to resign).

SPECIAL DISPENSATION

You are able to secure promotion for two members of staff at risk of leaving.

Play this card to skip the next two instances of churn.

EXPERIENCED HIRE

You manage to recruit a staff member with excellent knowledge of your policy area.

Play this card to have your next recruit start at level 4.



Churn in practice



Sessions with:

- Royal Society
- UKRI policy fellows
- Universities UK
- British Academy
- ESRC policy engagement team



Churn! for Researchers

Evidence and expertise are vital to improving policy

BUT Researchers often have little practical understanding of how policy making works and how to engage with it

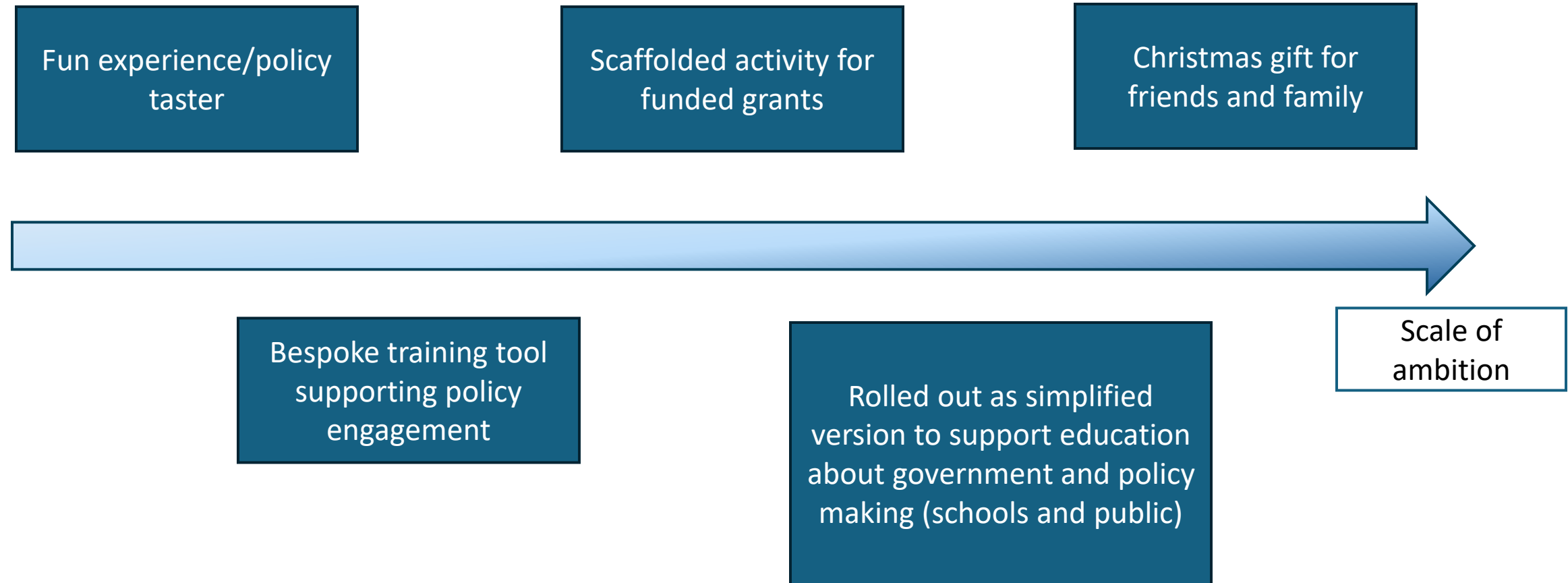
How Churn! helps:

Builds capability through a scalable policy-impact training tool that:

- Demystifies the world of politics and policy making
- Helps researchers understand how evidence gets caught into a wider system of governance and policy
- Demonstrates the value of evidence and engagement in improving policy
- Motivates and inspires policy engagement activity



What's next for Churn?



Quick reference guide

Phase A:

1. Move policy process counter down to next stage
2. Increase POLITICAL CAPITAL by one
3. Pick VOLATILITY card
4. Pick one (if volatility is 1-3) or two (if volatility is 4-6) POLITICAL EVENT cards*
5. CHURN - roll two dice and add volatility (see table)
6. ADVANCE all remaining staff members to the next level (unless your minister resigned).
7. Collect RESOURCE tokens
8. Pick two (if volatility is 1-3) or three (if volatility is 4-6) POLICY EVENT cards and add up the total policy response required

Phase B:

1. Meet policy response
2. Then you may:
 - a. Recruit (see cost below)
 - b. Purchase one of the resilience activities for this round
3. If resilience activity purchased, pay the cost and adjust POLITICAL CAPITAL and SCRUTINY
4. If your SCRUTINY score is above your POLITICAL CAPITAL at the end of Phase B, draw an additional POLITICAL EVENT card*.

NOTE: You may always exchange one type of token for another at an exchange rate of 2 to 1 (e.g. exchange 2 evidence tokens for 1 policy token, or 2 policy tokens for 1 delivery token).
You may also exchange 1 political capital for 2 tokens of any colour.

***If your minister resigns**, disregard any other political event cards and immediately determine new minister's political capital (see table). At the next opportunity for your staff to advance, only the expert may do so.

Churn (2 dice + volatility)

Score	Result
3-8	No churn
9-12	Lose one staff member
13 or more	Lose two staff members

Minister's starting political capital

If this is this your...	Roll one die and add...
First minister	3
Second minister	2
Third minister	1
Subsequent ministers	0

Recruitment cost

- Policy maker - 2 policy tokens
- Analyst - 2 policy tokens
- Operations - 2 policy tokens
- Expert – 1 policy, 1 evidence and 1 delivery token



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